

Thaddeus R. Winker

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LinkedIn|GitHub

Summary

Operations and Software Engineering leader with over a decade of experience supporting and scaling large, distributed software systems across hybrid onprem and cloud architectures. Over 2 years managing large, distributed technical teams across onshore and offshore locations. Customer and user facing leader who has built trust and satisfaction into the daily operations and redesigned support operations, eliminating repetitive ticket work, coaching engineers, and deploying AI and automation where they create real operational leverage. Experienced in service desk operations, end-user support, ticket triage, escalation management, and cross-functional coordination with Infrastructure, Networking, Cybersecurity, and Operations teams.

Brings a strong diagnostic foundation from early help desk experience, combined with modern leadership of Tier 2/3 support organizations in highly regulated, client-sensitive environments. Known for improving service delivery, reducing resolution times, strengthening communication standards, and developing high-performing support teams. Hands-on experience with system administration, server configuration, and troubleshooting user-impacting issues across hybrid on-prem/cloud environments.

Career History

Zelis(Formerly RedCard) — Jan 2017 – Present

Manager, Software Engineering (Apr 2024 – Present)

Team Coaching & Leadership

- Managed and coached 10+ engineers across onshore and offshore teams, providing technical direction, career development, hiring support, and performance feedback.
- Advanced 5+ engineers through targeted coaching, structured growth plans, and increased technical ownership.

Operational Improvements & Process Management

- Led transition to a squad-based model, improving ownership, autonomy, and delivery velocity.
- Designed and implemented a 24/7 on call rotation, establishing clear escalation paths and improving response consistency.
- Developed runbooks, SOPs, and troubleshooting guides to improve technical readiness and reduce repeat issues
- Partnered with infrastructure, networking, operations, client services, and product stakeholders to delivery reliable platform changes and resolve high-impact system issues.
- Built executive-recognized Jira Cloud dashboards and advanced filters that improved visibility into team capacity, throughput, work intake, and delivery risk.
- Partnered with executive leadership and strategic enablement leaders to develop reporting tools, assess capacity against work intake, and plan operational changes for the team.

- Led four-week sprint planning with QA and technical leads balancing planned fixes and enhancements with capacity for escalations, production support, code cutoffs, and QA cutoffs.

AI, Automation & Developer Productivity

- Introduced AI-based error classification and remediation guidance to reduce investigation time and senior-engineer dependency.
- Trained engineers on ML.Net and AI-assisted root-cause analysis, turning individual experimentation into repeatable team-owned tooling.
- Identified repetitive incident patterns and redesigned support workflows using machine learning, standard procedures, and operator training to reduce manual investigation and improve team independence.

Senior Software Engineer (Oct 2021 – Apr 2024)

- Provided Tier 3 support for complex user-impacting issues across a large distributed system.
- Performed administrative operations on production servers to resolve urgent issues affecting internal and external users.
- Led root-cause analysis efforts and partnered with Infrastructure and Engineering teams to remediate recurring problems.
- Met directly with clients and internal stakeholders to troubleshoot issues, explain root causes, and guide resolution plans.
- Partnered with engineering teams to remediate recurring failure patterns and improve system resilience and observability.
- Established technical standards for incident triage and escalation in a distributed services environment.

Software Engineer (Nov 2017 – Oct 2021)

- Partnered with business users, analysts, and management to translate requirements into software solutions for healthcare payment and financial document workflows.
- Developed systems for health insurance payment and financial document processing in a highly regulated healthcare technology environment.

Associate Software Engineer (Jan 2017 – Nov 2017)

- Troubleshoot production issues on a large-scale distributed system.
- Reviewed peer code and tested changes.

United Educators — Feb 2016 – Dec 2016

Associated Software Developer (Feb 2016 – Dec 2016)

- Resolved production issues for UE@Work.
- Developed new features and requirements.

Elite Personnel (For United Educators) — Jun 2014 – Feb 2016

Quality Assurance Engineer (Jun 2014 – Feb 2016)

- Gathered requirements and tested billing and accounting functionality of UE@Work.

Now You Know Media — May 2013 – Jun 2014

Assistant Producer (May 2013 – Jun 2014)

- Assisted in the production of media content, including video and audio materials.
 - Built a Microsoft Access royalty-payment system and provided internal technical support
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Leadership & Operational Management

- Engineering team leadership (onshore & offshore)
- Incident response ownership & escalation management
- Production operations & reliability management
- Hiring, performance management, and career development
- Budget ownership, compensation planning, and staffing strategy for engineering teams
- Cross functional coordination with Infrastructure, Networking, and Operations
- Process design, continuous improvement, and organizational change leadership
- Experience leading engineering teams in highly regulated, client-sensitive environments
- Scaling systems and teams in fast-growth organizations

Systems & Reliability Expertise

- Large scale, client facing web applications
- Distributed and legacy system support
- Production incident triage, root cause analysis, and remediation
- Technical debt management in operational environments
- AI enabled incident analysis and workflow automation
- Secure application design and operational risk management

Technical Foundations

- Windows server administration
 - IIS Configuration
 - FTP Server management
 - Jira (JSM, Cloud, Datacenter, Confluence)
 - Microsoft Teams Workflows
 - Powershell
 - C#/.NET (.NET Framework and .NET Core)
 - SQL & relational database design
 - Distributed Systems (WCF, gRPC)
 - Version control (Git)
 - ML.Net and applied machine learning in production workflows
 - Snowflake, AWS, Azure
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Education

The Catholic University of America — M.A. in Biblical Languages (Oct 2013)

Xavier University — B.A. (Honors) in Theology, Classics (May 2010)